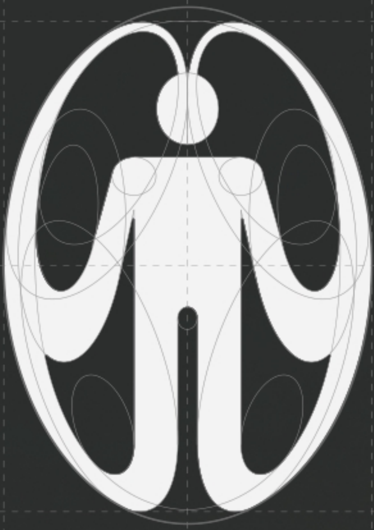
User manual



CTRL ONE BASIC OPERATION GUIDE
1ST EDITION
SERIAL No. 10001

HOW TO USE 8 INTERVENTIONS FOR AN ATTENTION YOU NO LONGER CONTROL

CASPER

ABSENT PRESENCE
IN THE PERIPHERAL
VISUAL ZONE

WHAT IT IS

Casper is a device made from a material that doesn't exist yet. A material that responds to where you look: if you're not looking directly at it, it isn't there. If you turn your eyes toward it, it appears. A completely normal phone when you're using it. An object that disappears when you're not.

It's not about hiding it, putting it away, or turning it off. It's about eliminating the one thing that triggers the impulse to pick it up when you don't need it: its presence at the edge of your field of vision.

Casper cuts the signal before it arrives.
No trigger, no pull. No pull, no action.

It's not the phone that changes.
It's the moment you decide to
look at it.

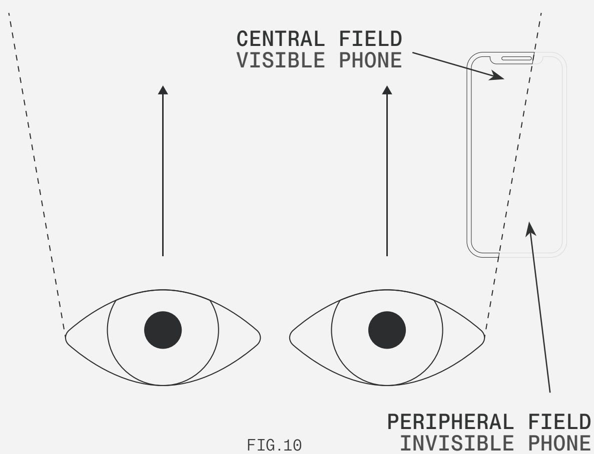


FIG.10

WHY IT WORKS

The human eye has a central field—where attention is conscious and details are sharp—and a peripheral field that operates automatically, without our conscious control. Peripheral vision does not read or analyze; it detects presence. And what it detects, it converts into a signal.

The phone on the table isn't in your central field of vision when you're working or reading. It's on the edge. And from that edge, it generates a continuous signal that your brain registers without you being aware of it: there it is, there it is, there it is. That signal competes with what you're doing. And at some point, without having made any real decision, you've picked it up. You didn't decide to pick it up. Your visual system did it for you.

ANATOMY OF THE OBJECT

Casper has the shape, size and functionality of any conventional smartphone. There is nothing about its appearance that sets it apart when you hold it in your hand and look at it. Screen, camera, buttons: everything works as normal when viewed head-on.

What sets it apart is the material of its casing and screen: a surface based on micro-slat technology (thousands of microscopic vertical slats that block visibility from angles other than the front) extended here beyond the screen to cover the entire device. Within the direct viewing cone the device is fully visible. Outside that cone, in the peripheral zone where the eye detects presence but not detail, the object becomes optically neutral: it does not reflect light in a recognisable way, it does not create contrast against the surroundings, it does not exist as a stimulus.

There is no switch. There is no mode to turn on. The device does the work on its own, at all times, without any user intervention.

HOW TO USE IT

Casper does not come with instructions for use in the conventional sense. It operates entirely passively: it requires no action, no adjustments, and no decisions. What follows is not an activation protocol—it is a description of what happens.

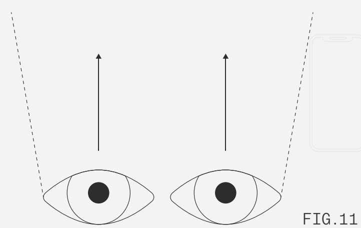


FIG.11

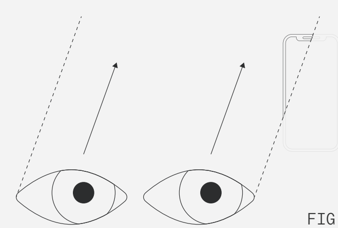


FIG.12

STEP 1 **USE IT JUST LIKE ANY OTHER PHONE**

Calls, messages, apps, camera. When you hold the device in your hand and look directly at it, it works exactly like any other smartphone.

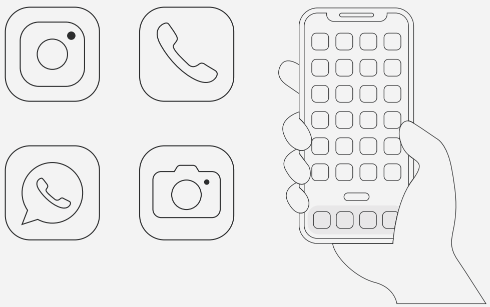


FIG.13

STEP 2 **LEAVE IT WHERE YOU NORMALLY WOULD**

On the table. On the couch. You don't need to hide it, put it away in any special place, or make any decisions about where to put it. Just leave it where you always would.

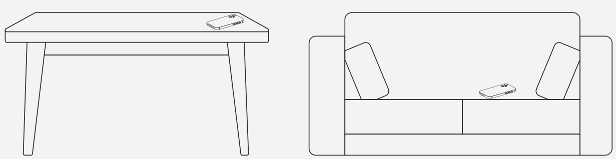


FIG.14

STEP 3 **THE OBJECT DISAPPEARS**

The moment your gaze stops focusing directly on it, the device ceases to exist as a visual stimulus. It's still physically there — you can pick it up whenever you like — but your peripheral vision no longer registers it. The low-intensity signal generated by its presence has been cut off.

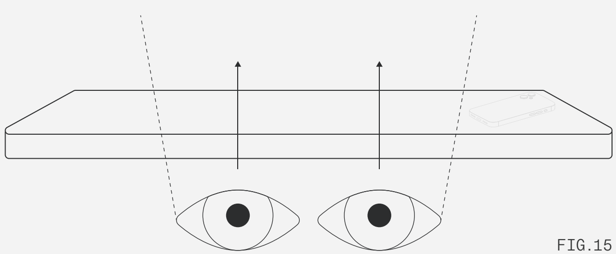


FIG.15

You haven't done anything. And yet, something has changed.

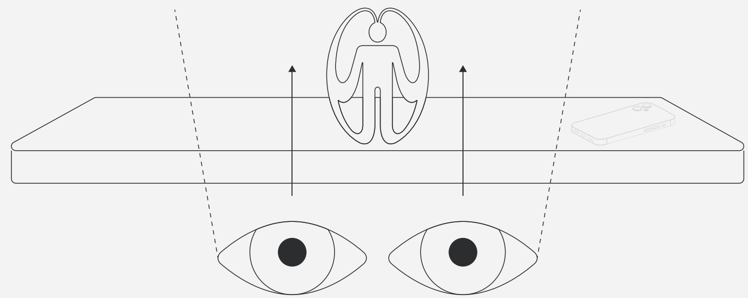


FIG.16

STEP 4 **DO WHAT YOU WERE GOING TO DO**

Work, read, rest, cook, talk. The environment you're in no longer contains the stimulus that triggered the reflexive impulse.The phone has stopped competing for your attention because it's no longer visible.

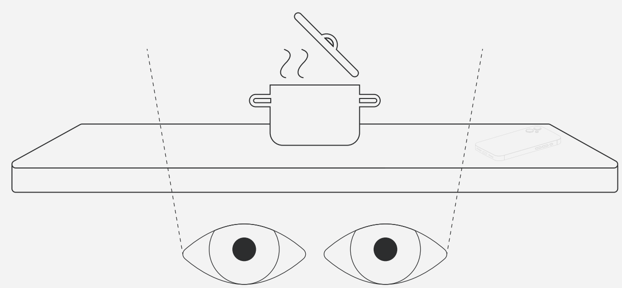


FIG.17

STEP 5 **PICK IT UP WHEN YOU NEED IT**

Turn your gaze back to it. As soon as it enters your direct field of vision, the device appears as normal. You pick it up, use it, put it down again. The cycle restarts itself.

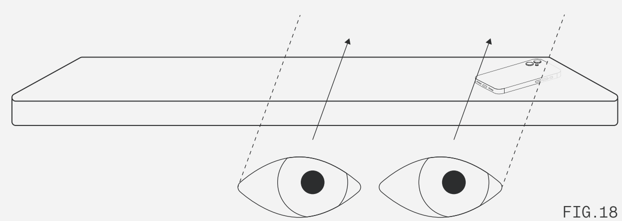


FIG.18

WHEN TO USE IT

Always. That is the answer, and it is also what sets it apart from every other intervention in this manual.

Most of the suggestions in Ctrl One require an action: putting your mobile down somewhere, activating something, or consciously deciding to take a break. Casper requires none of that. It operates at all times, in any context, without the user having to remember to use it. It is the only object in this manual that works whilst you sleep, whilst you work, whilst you eat and whilst you watch a film.

It is particularly relevant in environments where compulsive use is most easily triggered: the office desk, the dining table, the bedside table. All the places where the phone is present but shouldn't be competing for your attention.

WHAT CASPER DOESN'T DO

Casper doesn't stop you from using your phone.

IT DOESN'T BLOCK YOUR APPS.

IT DOESN'T TRACK YOUR SCREEN TIME.

IT DOESN'T GUILT TRIP YOU.

IT DOESN'T JUDGE YOU.

Casper doesn't disappear when you need it: as soon as you look at it, it's there.

Nor does it solve the problem if you already have your phone in your hand. Once the impulse has been triggered and the device is in your direct line of sight, Casper works just like any other smartphone. The intervention happens before that moment, not after.

It does just one thing, and it does it continuously and effortlessly: it removes the peripheral stimulus that triggers the gesture before the gesture occurs. It doesn't act on your behaviour. It acts on what triggers it.

The most effective treatment is the one you don't notice.

CURRENT LIMITATION

Micro-blade technology currently exists in the form of commercial screen protectors — but it only affects the screen, not the entire device. The phone remains visible as a physical object in its surroundings. Extending that effect to the entire casing with the same passive behaviour and without manual activation is not yet possible.

The gap is clear: there is no material that can autonomously distinguish between direct and peripheral vision without additional sensors or user intervention. Casper is speculative precisely in this regard.

The question that immediately springs to mind, however, is: how many of the times you've used your mobile today were actually a conscious decision?

Where the F**K is my phone

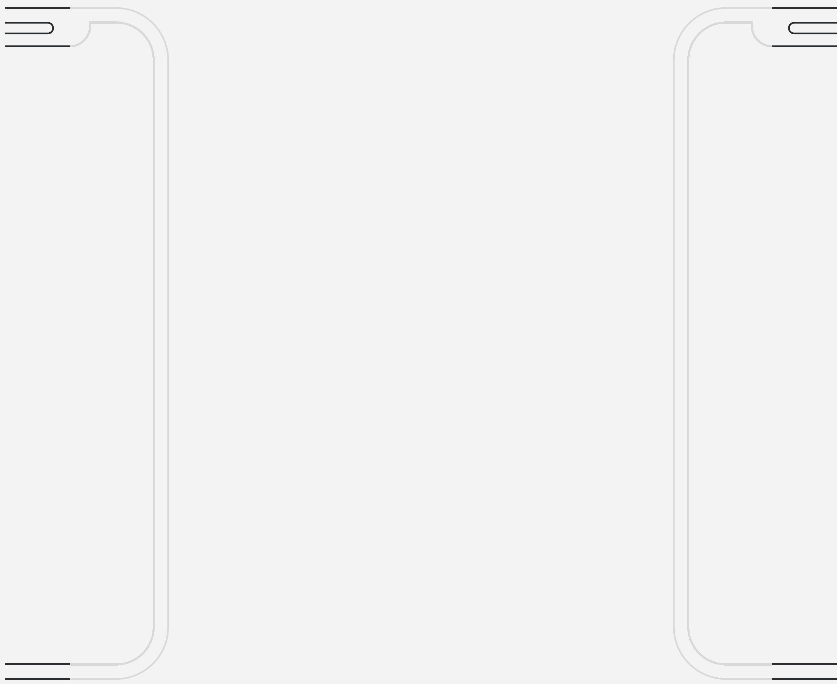


FIG.19